Budget Variance Explainer

Writes the story behind a number somebody else owns.

Do this, about two minutes

1. **Download the skill file budget-variance-explainer.zip**
   github.com/kesslernity/awesome-copilot-cowork-bots
2. In Cowork, open **Customize** in the side panel
3. Go to the **Skills** tab
4. Select the arrow next to **Add**, then **Upload skill**, and choose the file
5. Start a **new** chat and say one of these

   "Why are we over budget?"

   "Explain this variance"

   "What is behind the overspend?"

Nothing is sent, posted or deleted unless you press a button. **Changed your mind?** Remove the skill from the same **Skills** tab.

And you get back

- Written commentary in your house structure
- A table of causes, with evidence and how much each explains
- The remainder that stays unexplained, stated plainly

What it will never do without asking you

- Never calculate, recalculate or forecast. Not even arithmetic on supplied figures.
- Never state a cause as certain when the evidence is circumstantial. Label it.
- Never write commentary that attributes a variance to a named individual.

THE RULE IT FOLLOWS

"Largely unexplained" is an honest and useful answer.

Runs when you ask for it. Want it on a timer? Say *"do this every Monday at 9"* and Cowork schedules it. You get 25 schedules, so spend them on the jobs you would otherwise forget.

NEW TO COWORK?
It is the part of Copilot that *does the work*, not just the chatting. A skill is one file that teaches it a job you repeat.

YOU NEED
Microsoft 365 Copilot with Cowork switched on by your admin. It is off by default, and not on mobile.

IT IS METERED
Cowork bills on usage. Your admin can cap what you spend.

MAKE IT YOURS
Open *references/config.md* inside the file to set the names and thresholds.

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